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How to set up Proton VPN on an OpenWrt router using WireGuard

Reading

7 mins

Category

Routers

You can set up Proton VPN on your router, which will protect every device that connects to the internet using that router. In this guide, we take a step-by-step look at how to set up Proton VPN on an [OpenWrt](#) router using the WireGuard® VPN protocol.

You can also [configure Proton VPN on an OpenWrt router using OpenVPN](#), but we [recommend using WireGuard](#) unless you have a strong reason to use OpenVPN.

- [Learn more about why you should set up a VPN on your router.](#)
- [Learn more about WireGuard](#)

We also have guides for setting up Proton VPN on a wide selection of other popular routers.

On this page

How t...

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Before starting, you'll need the following:

- A computer that's connected to your LAN network so that you can [access your OpenWrt router's web interface](#). To do this, enter **192.168.1.1** into your browser's URL bar.

How to set up Proton VPN on an OpenWrt router

Step one: Download a WireGuard configuration file

Sign in to Proton VPN using your Proton Account username and password at account.protonvpn.com, go to **Downloads** → **WireGuard configuration**, and download a WireGuard configuration file. Be sure to **Select Platform: Router**.

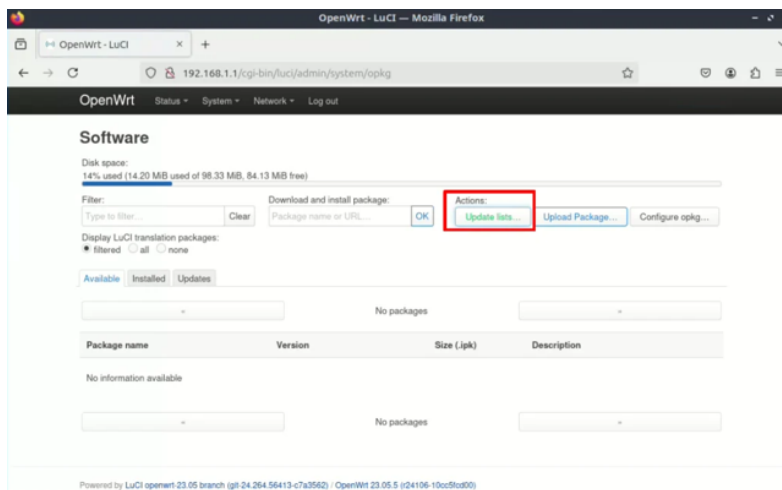
[Learn how to download a WireGuard configuration file from Proton VPN](#)

Step 2: Install WireGuard support

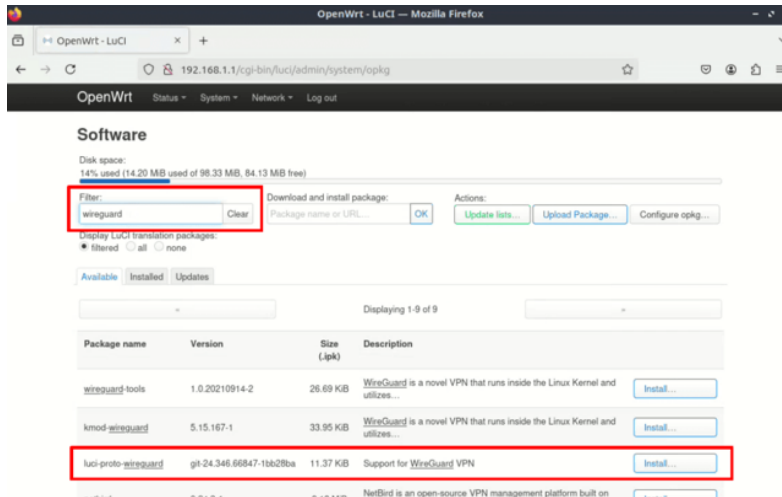
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How to set up your AsusWRT router for Proton VPN using WireGuard >

1. Open the OpenWrt web interface, sign in, and go to **System** → **Software** → **Actions** → **Update lists...**



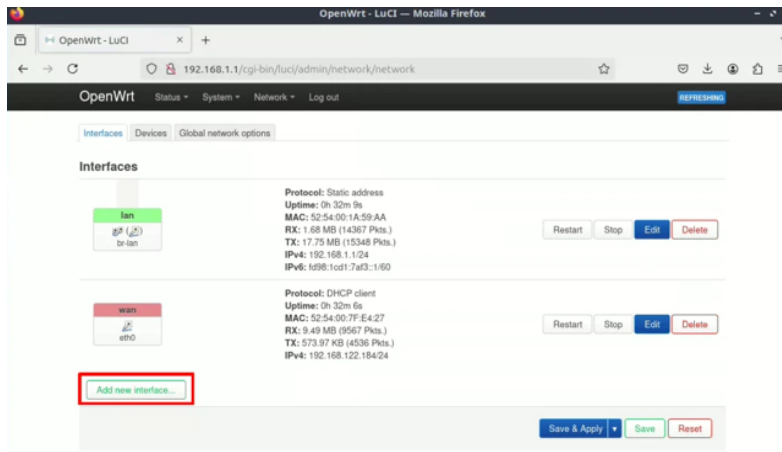
2. In the **Filter** field, enter WireGuard and select **luci-proto-wireguard** → **Install** from the package catalog search results (or **luci-app-wireguard** if you don't see this package).



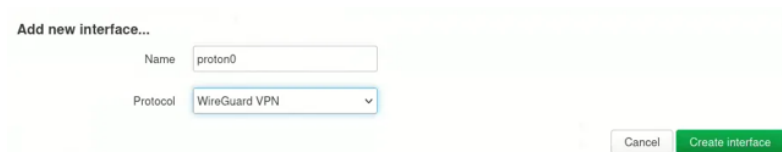
3. Turn your router off and then on again (you can do this through the web interface by going to **System** → **Reboot**).

Step three: Configure the WireGuard interface

1. Go to **Network** → **Interfaces** → **Add new interface...**



2. Give the new interface a name (such as **proton0**) and select **WireGuard VPN** from the **Protocol** dropdown menu. Click **Create interface** when you're done.



3. Go to **Import configuration** → **Load configuration...**

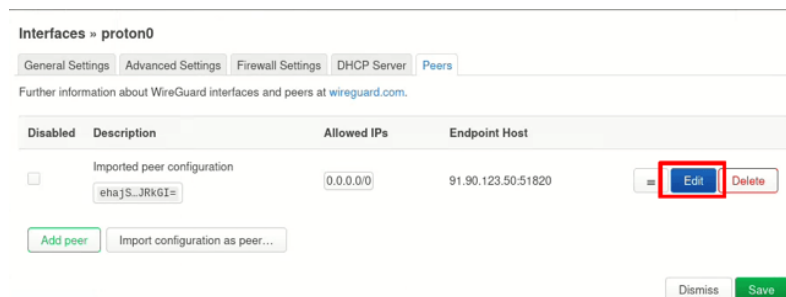


4. Open the WireGuard configuration file you downloaded in [step one](#) in a text editor, and paste its contents into the text box. Click **Import settings** when you're done.



5. On the new interface page, go to the **Peers** tab. Next to the only **Imported peer**

configuration, click **Edit**.



Interfaces » proton0

General Settings Advanced Settings Firewall Settings DHCP Server **Peers**

Further information about WireGuard interfaces and peers at wireguard.com.

Disabled	Description	Allowed IPs	Endpoint Host	
☐	Imported peer configuration ehajS...JRkGI=	0.0.0.0/0	91.90.123.50:51820	☐ Edit Delete

Add peer Import configuration as peer...

Dismiss **Save**

6. Go to **Route Allowed IPs** and ensure the checkbox is **selected**. Click **Save**.



Route Allowed IPs ☒

Optional. Create routes for Allowed IPs for this peer.

Endpoint Host

Optional. Host of peer. Names are resolved prior to bringing up the interface.

Endpoint Port

Optional. Port of peer.

Persistent Keep Alive

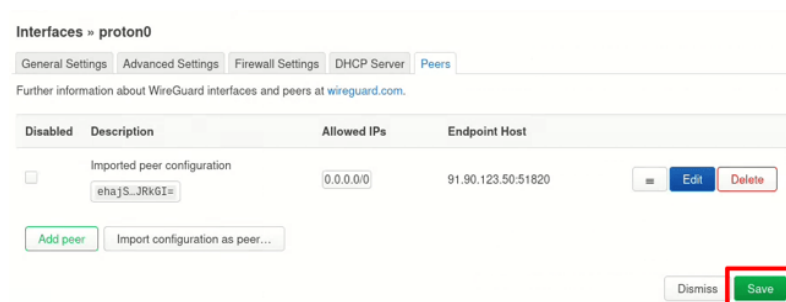
Optional. Seconds between keep alive messages. Default is 0 (disabled). Recommended value if this device is behind a NAT is 25.

Configuration Export ☐ Generate configuration...

Generates a configuration suitable for import on a WireGuard peer

Back **Save**

7. Back on the configuration page for your new WireGuard interface, click **Save**.



Interfaces » proton0

General Settings Advanced Settings Firewall Settings DHCP Server **Peers**

Further information about WireGuard interfaces and peers at wireguard.com.

Disabled	Description	Allowed IPs	Endpoint Host	
☐	Imported peer configuration ehajS...JRkGI=	0.0.0.0/0	91.90.123.50:51820	☐ Edit Delete

Add peer Import configuration as peer...

Dismiss **Save**

8. On the **Interfaces** page, click **Save & Apply**.

You'll lose all internet connectivity through the router, as all traffic is routed through the new interface but the firewall is not configured yet.

Step four: Configure the firewall

1. Go to **Network** → **Firewall** → **Zones** → **Add**.

2. Enter or select the following settings:

- **Name:** Choose a suitable name, such as **vpn**
- **Input:** Reject
- **Output:** Accept
- **Forward:** Reject
- **Masquerading:** Enabled
- **Covered networks:** Select WireGuard interface we created [Step three](#) (proton0 in our example).
- **Allow forward from source zones:** lan

3. Back on the **Zones** page, we need to edit the default LAN zone to ensure traffic is routed through the newly-created VPN zone. To do this, click **Edit** next to the **lan** zone.

4. Ensure the **MSS clamping** checkbox is **enabled**, then go to **Allow forward to destination zones** and **deselect** all zones except the VPN zone you just created (**vpn** in our case). Click **Save** when you're done.

Step four: Configure DNS

To prevent [DNS leaks](#), we need to ensure that OpenWrt uses Proton VPN's DNS server, not your ISPs.

1. **Network** → **Interfaces** → **wan** → **Edit**.

2. Go to the **Advanced Settings** tab → **Use DNS servers advertised by peer** and **deselect** the checkbox. A new **Use custom DNS servers** option will appear. Enter **10.2.0.1** (Proton VPN's DNS server address) → **+**. Click **Save** when you're done and, then **Save & Apply** back on the main **Interfaces** page.

Your OpenWrt router is now configured to route all connections through the VPN server you chose in **Step one**. Visit [our free secure IP scanner](#) to check that the VPN is working correctly, and browserleaks.com/dns to ensure there are no DNS leaks.

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